

Japan Semiconductors

SoftBank Group Corp

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

9984.JP

11,100 JPY



David Dai, CFA
+852 29 18 5704
david.dai@bernsteinsg.com



Jack Lin
+852 2123 2683
jack.lin@bernsteinsg.com



Juho Hwang
+81 3 6777 6980
juho.hwang@bernsteinsg.com



Carmine Milano, CFA
+44 20 7762 1857
carmine.milano@bernsteinsg.com

Quick Take: SoftBank's NAV could be boosted by OpenAI's potential \$1.2tn valuation

OpenAI's valuation potentially increases in the next up round funding. [OpenAI is reportedly considering another private funding round at a valuation of around \\$1.2tn ahead of its eventual IPO.](#) The discussions are still at an early stage and were reportedly initiated by large investors, rather than OpenAI itself, with the final valuation, deal size and timing yet to be determined. A \$1.2tn valuation would represent a c.41% uplift from OpenAI's \$852bn post-money valuation following its \$122bn funding round in March 2026. While no transaction has been confirmed, investor interest in a potential up-round underscores continued confidence in OpenAI's technology leadership and the commercial traction of its latest models. [Sam Altman has indicated that OpenAI is unlikely to list before 2027](#), noting that the current environment would be an "ill-advised" time to go public given the broader debate around AI safety.

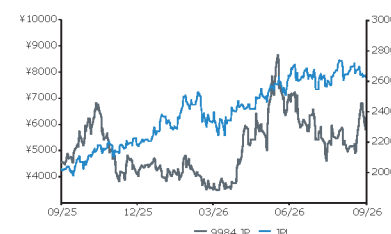
SoftBank's NAV could grow 12% if OpenAI's valuation increases. If OpenAI's valuation reaches \$1.2tn, we estimate SoftBank's NAV would be +12% to \$381bn. A higher OpenAI valuation would mechanically widen the implied net asset value (NAV) discount, and with the \$381bn pro-forma NAV, the current NAV discount would expand to 40%, vs. 33% based on OpenAI's current c.\$852bn valuation (Exhibit 1-2). We continue to believe the Arm share price appreciation and OpenAI potential IPO would be catalysts to further reduce the NAV discount, as the current discount is already below the historical average of ~46% (Exhibit 3).

Reiterate Outperform on SoftBank. Besides OpenAI, [SB Energy recently filed for IPO and reportedly seeks \\$50bn in valuation](#), which would further boost the SoftBank Group NAV. Given SoftBank's strategic positioning across the AI value chain, including its exposure to OpenAI, Arm, SB Energy, and broader AI infrastructure, we believe the company will be one of the largest long-term beneficiaries of the AI ecosystem. We reiterate our **Outperform** rating on the stock and ¥11,100 target price.

Close Date	17 Sep 2026			
9984.JP Close Price (JPY)	6,247.00			
Price Target (JPY)	11,100			
Upside/(Downside)	78%			
52-Week Range	9,074.00/3,365.00			
JPL	2,636.37			
FYE	Mar			
Div Yield	0.2%			
Market Cap (JPY) (B)	35,681.92			
EV (JPY) (B)	60,346.81			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	42.0	7.2	66.6	36.9
JPL (%)	19.5	(3.4)	12.8	30.9
Relative (%)	22.5	10.6	53.8	6.0

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
9984.JP (JPY)	872.47	204.81	161.94

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Reported EPS	872.47	204.81	161.94	--
Revenues (M)	7,799*	8,528*	8,815*	--
EBIT (M)	7,282*	4,139*	3,258*	(33.1)%

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Adjusted P/E (x)	7.2	30.5	38.6
EV/EBIT (x)	8.3	14.6	18.5

*Values shown in billions; Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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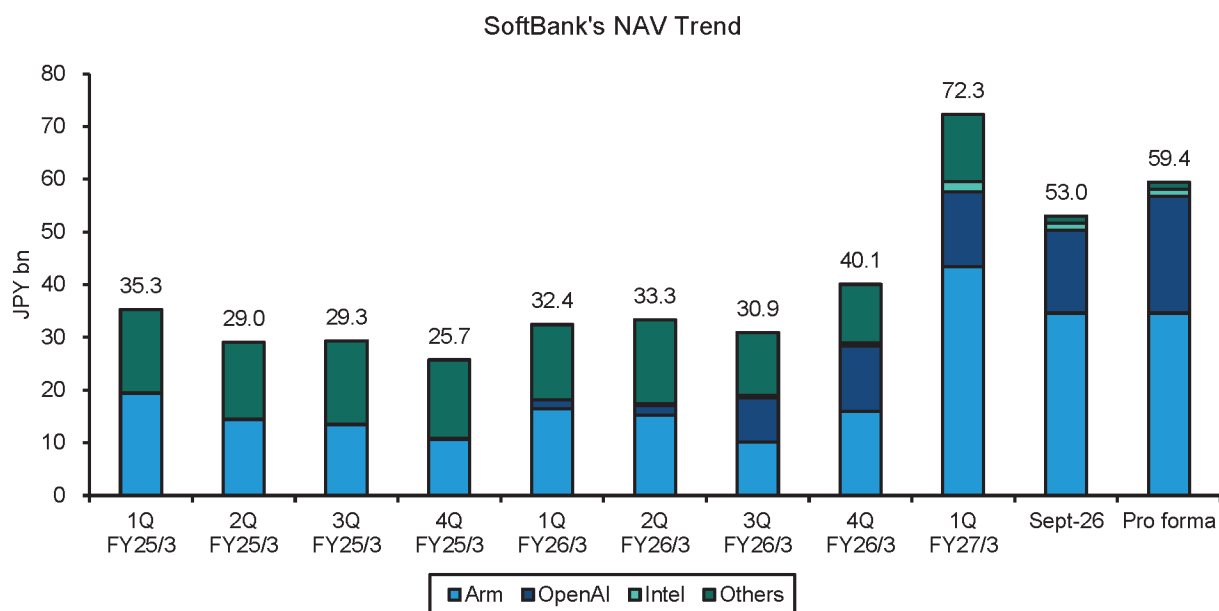
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EXHIBIT 1: **SoftBank NAV could be boosted by 12% with OpenAI new valuation**

Softbank's 1-year NAV to valuation (USDbn)	OAI Current Target	OAI Current Current	OAI New Current
Arm per share value (USD)	480.00	243.98	243.98
Share Count (mn)	1,052	1,052	1,052
Market cap (USD bn)	504,960	256,667	256,667
% holding	86.4%	86.4%	86.4%
OpenAI Valuation (USD bn)	852	852	1,200
% holding	11.8%	11.8%	11.8%
Future NAV (USD bn)			
Arm	436.3	221.8	221.8
OpenAI	100.6	100.6	141.7
Intel	12.1	8.8	8.8
Others	8.7	8.7	8.7
Total	557.7	339.8	380.9
Total (JPY tn)	90.4	53.0	59.4
Discount	30%	33%	40%
Share Count (mn)	5,699	5,699	5,699
Target Price (JPY)	11,100	n.a.	n.a.
Current Price (JPY)	6,247	6,247	6,247
Upside/Downside	78%	n.a.	n.a.

(1) OAI represents OpenAI; (2) Share prices are as of 17th September 2026; except for Arm and Intel, whose share prices are as of 16th September 2026; and (3) Arm's pro forma share price is based on Bernstein's latest price target, while Intel's pro forma share price is based on the share price as of Bernstein's latest report publication date, 7th August 2026, when we determined our SoftBank price target.

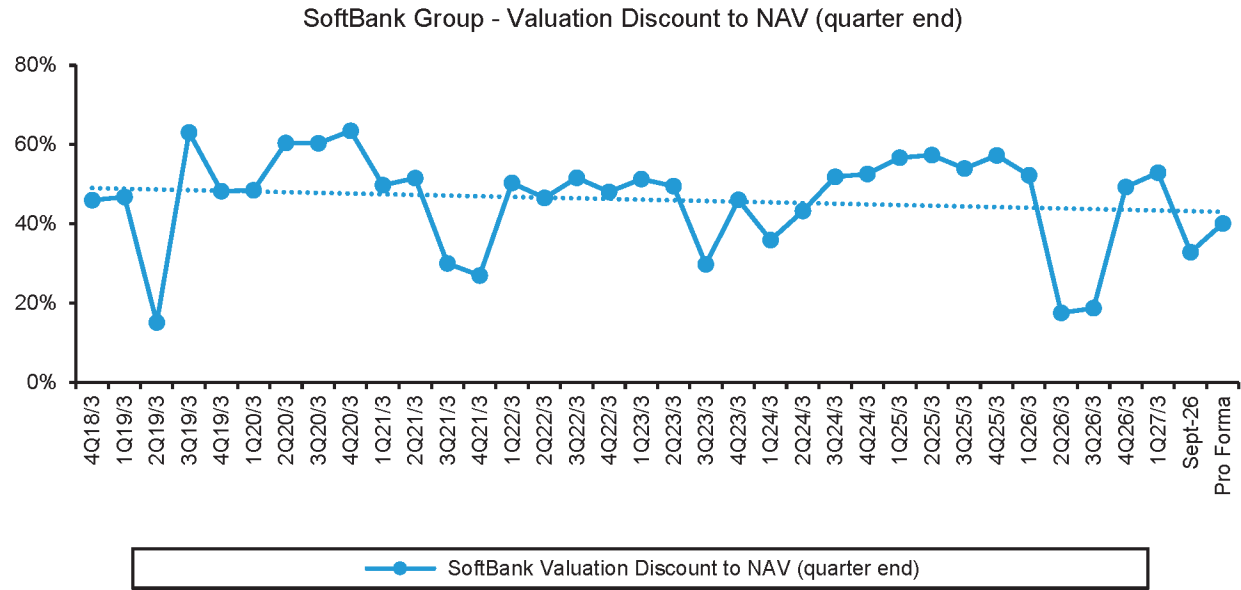
Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 2: **SoftBank Group - NAV Trend**

Sept-26: as of 17th September, 2026.

Source: Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 3: **SoftBank Group - Valuation Discount to NAV**



Sept-26: as of 17th September, 2026.
Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate SoftBank Group **Outperform** with PT = **¥11,100**.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	17 Sep 2026 Closing Price	Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
						Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
9984.JP (SoftBank)	O	JPY	6,247.00	11,100	6.0%	JPY	872.47	204.81	161.94	7.2	30.5	38.6
JPL			2,636.37									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**SoftBank Group Corp**

For SoftBank, we apply a 30% discount to our one-year forward net asset value (NAV) of \$557bn, with a USD/JPY of 162.14, to derive our PT of ¥11,100.

RISKS**SoftBank Group Corp**

Downside risks to our price target for SoftBank include: (1) lower-than-expected valuation for Arm, driven by slower growth in its emerging AGI CPU business and limited market share gains in the server CPU segment; (2) potential market share loss at OpenAI amid intensifying competition; (3) execution risk in OpenAI's monetization strategy, particularly its ability to scale revenues to offset rising operating expenses and computing costs; and (4) financial stability risks, including potential credit-rating downgrades, stemming from continued large-scale investments in OpenAI and other strategic initiatives.

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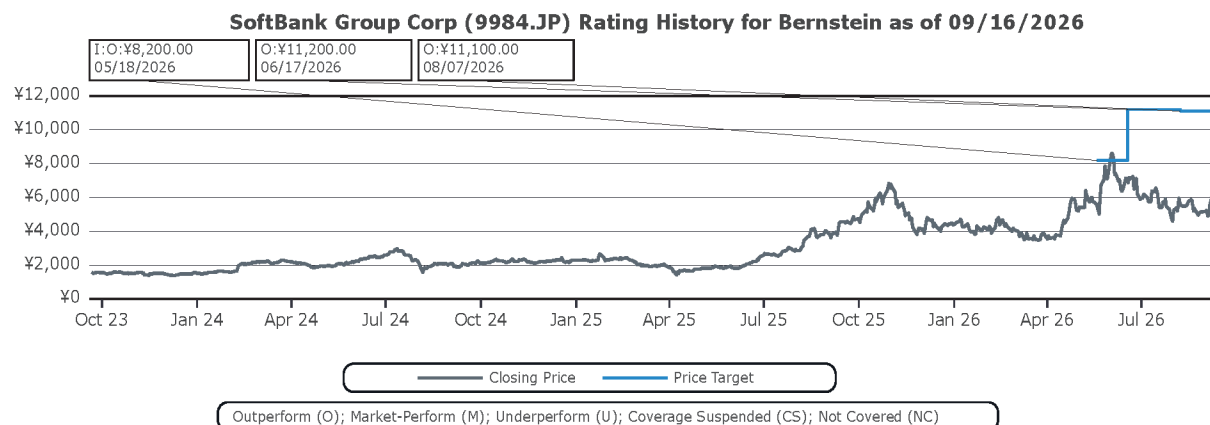
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Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months. As of June 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

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